Pathum Egodawatta

interdciplinary designer, thinker & catalyst

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+97 716 181 108

With over a decade of experience in supervising and managing type design projects, orgnising cumunities, curating cultural knoweldge exchnges and multitude of art and media production projects, I am verstaile thought leader and a builder focused on Lanak identity and South Asian knowledge and culture.

Interests
— Encoding, fonts and typography of South Asian writing systems
— AI, design and education
— Decolonisation and national identities

Scripts engaged
Latin, Sinhala, Tamil, Thaana, Thai

Technical proficiency
— Font engineering and Encoding
— AI for Design and Culture

Research areas
— Multiscript typography
— Language as infrastructure
— Cultural exports and design
— Nation building and design

Educational qualifications

2016 **MA Typeface Design (2015–2016), University of Reading, UK**
Graduated with Distinction

2013 **BA (Hons) in Graphic Design (2010–2013), Academy of Design Colombo Northumbria University, UK**
Graduated with First class, Valedictorian

Professional experience

2017– **Director, Mooniak (Managing partner)**
Running typography and type design consultancy service

2025– **Visiting lecturer on design** *at the University of Moratuwa, Sri Lanka*

2017– **Visiting lecturer on typography** *at the Academy of Design, Colombo*

2015 **Faculty member at CraftingType.com** *on South Asian Scripts*

2014 **Font engineer, Rossetta Type Foundry** *(Part time - Oct 2016–January 2017)*

2013 **Consultant to Google Fonts (Contract - April 2014–July 2015)**
Leading Google Fonts Sinhala web font development with an international team that included Latin, Tamil and Sinhala type designers, font engineers and software engineers, and spanned type design, font engineering, software development of build processes and substantial contributions to open source font editor applications.

2013 **Junior Art Director, Grant McCann McCann Worldwide, Sri Lanka**
(Full time - Oct 2013–April 2014)

2013 **Teaching Assistant-Graphic Design , Academy of Design , Sri Lanka**
(Full time - June 2013–Sep 2014)

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Organisations and contributions

Director of Institute of Typography
Developing latest update to the Sri Lanka Standard for Infirmation Interchange

Contributions to Unicode Standard (December 2017–)
Member of Lanka Local Languages Working Group currently collaborating with Unicode editors on rewriting Unicode Standard Core Specification for Sinhala.

GNU GPL font licensing (December 2017–April 2018)
Advising Free Software Foundation on font exception in GNU General Public License and font embedding related technologies in PDF files.

Hanthana Linux (December 2017–April 2018)

Notable technical projects

SLS 1134: Fourth Revision draft (January 2025–)
Developing latest update to the Sri Lanka Standard for Information Interchange.

Contributions to Unicode Standard (December 2017–)
Member of Lanka Local Languages Working Group currently collaborating with Unicode editors on rewriting Unicode Standard Core Specification for Sinhala.

Sinhala Generation Panel - ICANN (December 2017–April 2018)
Member of the Sinhala Generation Panel for Root Zone Sinhala Lable Generation Rules (SinhalaGP)

GNU GPL font licensing (December 2017–April 2018)
Advicing Free Software Foundation on font exception in GNU General Public License and font embedding related technologies in PDF files.

Contributions to Fontforge (2014–2018)
Maintained the issue tracker and contributed to major revamp of UI. Updated the website and documentation.

Unified Font Repository and related projects (2019–)
Contributions to various font packaging standards and open source projects for font distribution.

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Knowledge projects

Typoday 2017
I led the international Typoday 2017 event, successfully securing funding, partnerships, and global promotion. This initiative created new opportunities and collaborations in typography for Sri Lanka, ultimately leading to the formation of the Akuru Collective.

The Typography Educators Forum 2017
I conceived and led The Typography Educators Forum, which successfully fostered new teaching techniques for undergraduate design courses. Through this initiative, I empowered graphic design educators to develop fundamental tools for improving typographic execution and crafting skills.

Dutch–Ceylon Typographic Heritage Project
I directed a heritage project dedicated to exploring the shared typographic and printing history between Sri Lanka and The Netherlands. This initiative specifically highlighted 18th-century Sinhala and Tamil type-making by the Dutch Press, fostering significant cultural exchange and knowledge.

Galle Font Project
I led the Galle Font Project, focusing on developing a digital typeface based on 18th-century Dutch Press letterforms for cultural preservation. I directed the initial research and proof-of-concept design, preparing for the open-source release of this historical font revival.

AkuruCon 2018
I orchestrated AkuruCon 2018 in collaboration with the Dutch Embassy, celebrating 280 years since the introduction of movable type in Sri Lanka. This event featured impactful workshops and seminars on shared typographic history, engaging diverse participants from design and public sectors.

ATypI Working Seminars 2019
I commissioned and led the largest project to capture and build a comprehensive video library of the 2022 Sri Lankan protests.

Media projects

Kolonbiya
I am the founder and executive producer of Kolonbiya, a popular YouTube Sinhala drama series with a loyal youth cult following. I conceptualised and co-founded the project and led the creative vision. The show is known for its sharp humour, subtle political commentary, and groundbreaking storytelling that mainstreamed discussions on marijuana usage, mass migration, and psychedelics in subtle artistic ways. The channel has over 180K subscribers with a loyal audience base.

ko Universe
I conceived and founded Ko Universe, a YouTube channel built on the Kolonbiya universe to deepen discussions on the themes explored in the series. Since its founding, the channel has built a 25,000-strong following with sporadic content, podcasts, and commentary on political subjects and thematic content.

Now they are few, we are many
I conceptualised and produced a viral video titled “Now, They Are Few. We Are Many” aimed at the armed forces during the 2022 protests, which gained over four million combined views on social media. The video was designed to shift the perspective of members of the armed forces to stand with the protesting public.

2022 Protest video archive
I commissioned and led the largest project to captrue and build a large library of the 2022 Sri Lankan protests.